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THE BOLLES SCHOOL
BULLDOGS LACROSSE
SENIOR LEADERSHIP

BUILDING IDENTITY · ELEVATING LEADERS · EMPOWERING TEAMS

THE CAPTAIN'S FIELD GUIDE · BOLLES BULLDOGS LACROSSE

IRONMIND ELITE

for the Senior Leaders of Bolles Lacrosse

Mental toughness, leadership that holds under pressure, and a plan for what comes after your last game — not just this season.

"The arena doesn't end when the final buzzer sounds. It changes shape."

IRONMIND ADVISORS

WANT THE FULL CURRICULUM?

If you want the full curriculum, you must text me at **404-831-1961** and request it. I'm not making you do this. It's only for those who want it.

— Coach Kenny

26-27

PREPARED FOR

The Bolles School

Men's Lacrosse · Senior Leadership Group

YOUR COACH

Kenny Stoddart

Mental Strength & Leadership Coach
"Coach Kenny"

SEASON

2026-27

Jacksonville, FL · ironmindadvisors.com

PRIVATE — YOURS TO KEEP · WRITE IN IT

This guide is one of four things you just got.

Most people hand you a packet and call it leadership training. That is not what this is. When you stepped into this group, four things became yours — and three of them are people, not paper.

1 • The Field Guide

Seven sections and seven tools covering identity, anticipation, leading your teammates, energy, recruiting, mentorship, and a daily operating protocol. All of it has been used by real people under real pressure. Nothing is theoretical.

2 • Direct access to me

I am not a guest speaker who shows up once and disappears. You have my phone. If a conversation with a coach is coming and you want to game-plan it, text me. If a teammate is falling apart and you don't know what to say, text me. If a college coach emails you and you want a second set of eyes, send it. Follow the work on Instagram: [@ironmindkenny](#).

3 • My network

I spent 27 years building relationships with leaders across technology, medicine, law, finance, professional sport, and the trades — people who hire, who build teams, and who take my call. That network is open to you now, and it doesn't expire when you graduate.

4 • The seniors in this room

You are not doing this alone, and that is by design. The group in front of you is going through the same last season and the same question about what happens next. Use them.

★ PUT THIS IN YOUR PHONE RIGHT NOW

Our senior leadership session: _____ **at** _____. Before you read another page, put it in your calendar with a reminder the night before. The guys who get the most out of this are the ones who show up every week, not the ones who read the hardest.

WHERE THIS STOPS

I coach mental strength and leadership. I am not your therapist, and this guide is not clinical care. If something you're carrying is heavier than a coaching conversation — and some things are — tell me, tell your parents, or go to the Bolles counseling office. In a crisis, call or text **988**. Asking for help is not a break in the chain of command.

What's in this guide

Front

Foreword — Why I'm standing in your locker room

A note from me — Read this carefully. Once.

Core sections

- 01** The IronMind Foundation — Mental toughness and identity
- 02** Mental Anticipation — Win the week before the game
- 03** Leading Your Teammates — The captain's actual job
- 04** Energy, Boundaries & Burnout — Protecting the engine

- 05** Recruiting & What Comes After the Last Game
- 06** Mentor-On-Call — Finding, using, and becoming one
- 07** The IronMind Daily Protocol — How elite performers operate
- 08** Closing Charge — "You were built for this"

Tools you will fill in

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	WHEN TO USE IT
The Pre-Game Mindset Audit	Five questions that put your head where your body already is	Before any game, test, or hard conversation
The Challenge Map	Names what can go wrong and your answer for each	Start of the season; before any big push
The Captain's Standard Sheet	Defines the standard you will hold — in writing, so it isn't a mood	Once, early. Then revisit monthly
The Energy Ledger	Tracks what fills you and what drains you across a week	Weekly, all season
The Transition Brief	Separates what you control from what you don't in recruiting	Now, and every time the noise gets loud
The Ask & the Prep Sheet	How to reach an adult who doesn't know you — and not waste the meeting	Before every mentor or coach conversation
The Weekly Scorecard	Game film for your life, reviewed without ego	Every Sunday night

"You didn't earn a starting spot and a senior year to walk into the rest of your life unprepared. You earned the right to compete. This is your playbook."

KENNY STODDART, FOUNDER — IRONMIND ADVISORS

Why I'm standing in your locker room

I didn't take this on because it looked like a good business. I took it on because I lived the thing I am trying to keep you from living — and nobody warned me.

For 27 years I worked in cybersecurity, a field where the margin for error is razor-thin. I led global teams through crises that never made the news. I sat across the table from executives making million-dollar decisions in real time. On paper I was everything the world tells you to want, and I got there young.

Underneath it, I was coming apart. The higher I climbed, the less I recognized myself. I got very good at wearing what I now call the Superman cape — composed, capable, crushing it in every meeting — while privately dealing with depression, burnout, unhealthy ways of coping, and a body that was breaking down. I believed that asking for help was the one thing a leader could never do. Eventually the pressure caught up with me and I lost nearly everything.

That's when I made the decision that changed my life. I went all in on fixing myself. I asked for help. I got honest with the people who mattered. And I put the same structure and discipline behind rebuilding my life that I had spent 27 years putting behind a career.

What I found underneath the burnout was the real problem: **I had lost my identity.** I was "Ken the executive." I no longer knew who Kenny was.

Rebuilding took exactly what Ironman racing takes — a plan, daily reps, and people who wouldn't let me quit. I've since finished ten Ironman races and beaten Stage 3 cancer. I went back and earned my MBA from The Citadel's Baker School of Business, and I'm finishing my Master's in Clinical Mental Health Counseling at Liberty University, because I wanted real clinical training behind the lived experience before I ever coached anyone through theirs.

Here's why I'm giving this to seniors

Once I came out the other side, I started paying attention, and I could not stop seeing it. Talented young people walking out of a team and into the rest of their lives completely underprepared for what was waiting. Not underprepared athletically. Not underprepared academically. **Underprepared mentally.** Underprepared for the day the schedule disappears and nobody tells them what time to show up.

I've sat across from twenty-five-year-olds who had every talent in the world and were quietly unraveling, because no one gave them the tools for the transition. I recognized it immediately. It was the early version of my own story — starting twenty-five years sooner than it started for me.

What I already know about you

You compete. You have been up before sunrise for a lift you didn't feel like doing. You have been coached hard in front of people. You have failed publicly and come back the next day anyway. You know what it costs to perform when it actually matters.

That edge is real. It is transferable. But only if you know how to use it — and almost nobody teaches you how. Most guys hand the edge back the day they take off the jersey.

You also have something specific in front of you this year. Last season you were a junior on this team. Now you are the standard. The younger guys are watching what you do when practice gets ugly, when the officiating goes against you, when a coach gets on you, when it's 6:15 a.m. and it's raining. They are not reading your leadership. They are copying your behavior.

So here is what you should expect from me. I will give you the advice I wish somebody had given me at eighteen, and I'll give it to you straight. I'll open my network to you, because access is the thing young people need most and get least. And I will show up, on the record, to answer whatever you bring me.

Been there. Done that. Learned it the expensive way so that you don't have to.

"The game is still going. Your competition is still preparing. The only question is whether you are."

IRONMIND ADVISORS

My mission is to build leaders who carry mental toughness not as a slogan but as an operating system. Guys who set standards without burning relationships. Who find mentors without being transactional. Who protect their energy, handle pressure, and show up as leaders rather than as the oldest players on the roster.

Every chapter here was written from lived experience — mine, and that of the athletes I've had the honor of coaching. Every tool has been field-tested. Nothing is theoretical. Everything is actionable.

Let's get to work.

Kenny Stoddart

Founder & CEO, IronMind Advisors · "Coach Kenny"

27-Year Cybersecurity Executive · Jon Gordon Certified Trainer · MA, Clinical Mental Health Counseling, Liberty University 2026 · 10× Ironman · Stage 3 Cancer Survivor · The Citadel '97 · Citadel MBA '24

Read this carefully. Once.

I need you to know something before we go any further: **I am going to ask you hard questions.** Not to embarrass you. Not to judge you. Because I take your future seriously, and I need you to take it seriously too.

I'm going to ask you about your self-esteem — how you actually feel about yourself when nobody is clapping for you, when you're on the sideline, when the offer you wanted didn't come. I'm going to ask about your wellness: your sleep, your stress, your head, the things you quietly carry and tell no one. And I'm going to ask about your fitness — not just your numbers in the weight room, but whether you are treating yourself like the high-performing human being you have the capacity to be.

These conversations can feel uncomfortable. They're supposed to.

Now a real one, from me to you

I will not engage with unnecessary drama. If you bring me complaints that aren't connected to growth, I'm going to redirect you. If you want to vent about a teammate without taking any accountability yourself, I'll care about you enough to say so. I don't say that to be harsh. I say it because real mentorship isn't about making you feel good in the moment — it's about making you ready for the long game.

My lack of response to chaos is not a lack of care. It is the opposite.

Every hard question I ask, every moment I hold you to a higher standard, every time I refuse to co-sign your excuses — that is me showing up for you the way I wish someone had shown up for me.

WHAT STAYS BETWEEN US

What you bring me stays with me. I am not a pipeline to your head coach, your teachers, or your parents, and I will not trade your trust for information. The one exception is safety: if I believe you or someone else is in danger, I will involve the adults who need to be involved, and I will tell you I'm doing it. That is the deal. It doesn't change.

You didn't end up in this group by accident. Your coaches put you here because something in you already knows you're capable of more.

Let's get to work.

— Coach Kenny



The IronMind Foundation

Mental Toughness Principles

"Your mind is your most powerful asset — and the only one nobody can take from you."

- What mental toughness actually means
 - The 4 Pillars
 - Energy, positivity, and team culture
 - The Identity Framework
 - Identity gain vs. identity loss
 - **Tool: The Pre-Game Mindset Audit**
-

What mental toughness actually means

Let's start by dismantling a myth. Mental toughness is not being emotionally numb. It is not grinding until you collapse. It is not a personality trait reserved for Navy SEALs and Hall of Famers.

Mental toughness, as IronMind defines it, is **the disciplined integration of self-awareness and performance under pressure**. You know yourself well enough to manage your reactions, and you've built the habits to deliver when the moment demands it.

Pressure on this team looks like a lot of things. It's the fourth quarter of a one-goal game. It's a coach getting on you in front of everyone and having to take it without your face changing. It's the hardest test of the semester the morning after a road game. It's a teammate quitting on a rep and you deciding whether to say something. It's losing a starting spot to a junior and choosing how you show up at practice the next day. Mental toughness is what keeps you in the game when the game gets uncomfortable.

"Mental toughness isn't the absence of struggle. It's the ability to perform through it — with your values intact."

IRONMIND ADVISORS

The IronMind Identity Framework

Who are you when no one is watching? This is the foundational question of the IronMind program. Your identity — the core beliefs you hold about who you are and what you're capable of — determines your behavior more than any skill or stat line ever will. When things get hard, you don't rise to the level of your goals. **You fall to the level of your identity.**

For a senior, identity is the most vulnerable thing on the table, and almost nobody says it out loud. For most of your life, "lacrosse player at Bolles" has answered the question of who you are. It set your schedule, your friend group, your standards, and how people introduced you. Sometime in the next twelve months, most of that scaffolding comes down — for some of you all at once, on a Saturday afternoon, after a final horn.

That's when a lot of high performers hit a quiet crisis: *if I'm not a lacrosse player, who am I?* IronMind exists to answer that question before you have to ask it in a panic — and to redirect that competitive identity into something every bit as powerful.

▲ IRONMIND PRINCIPLE

The people who struggle most in transitions aren't the ones who lacked talent. They're the ones who never learned to separate their **performance** from their **personhood**. Your results don't define you. Your character does. Anchor your identity to your values — not your minutes, not your stats, not your commitment status.

The 4 Pillars of Mental Toughness

PILLAR	WHAT IT MEANS	IN PRACTICE
Composure	Regulating emotion under pressure without suppressing it	Three breaths before you answer a coach who just lit you up; not retaliating after a cheap hit
Consistency	Showing up at your best regardless of conditions	Same warm-up before a rival game and a scrimmage; same effort when you're up eight and down eight
Coachability	Receiving hard feedback without defending, deflecting, or collapsing	Asking "what would you have done differently?" and actually writing the answer down
Courage	Acting in line with your values when it costs you something	Saying the thing nobody in the locker room wants named; telling a friend his behavior is hurting the team

Identity gain vs. identity loss

Every major transition involves both. This year you gain roles: senior, captain, the guy people come to, the recruit, the college student. You also lose the structures that told you who you were — practice at the same time every day, a locker room that was handed to you, a scoreboard that told you objectively whether you were doing well.

IronMind calls this **the Identity Gap** — the space between who you were and who you're becoming. Most people sprint across it and hope. High performers live in it on purpose. They mine their athletic identity for the transferable assets — leadership, resilience, coachability, team orientation, the ability to be corrected in public — and deliberately install those assets into whatever comes next.

I know that gap personally. I spent 27 years so fused to my job title that when it went away, I didn't know who I was without it. The difference between us is timing. I hit that wall in my forties. You're getting the map at eighteen.

Energy, positivity, and team culture

As a Jon Gordon Certified Trainer, I use the Energy Bus philosophy throughout this program. The premise: **you are the driver of your own bus**. You choose who rides with you, you set the direction, you fuel the engine. Positivity is not naive optimism — it is a competitive advantage. Positive emotional states broaden thinking, increase resilience, and improve problem-solving under stress.

- **Your energy is contagious.** You bring either life or drain to every room and every huddle you walk into. Choose deliberately, because as a senior your choice is multiplied.
- **Positivity is a discipline, not a feeling** that happens to you when things go well.
- **Culture is built by behavior, not by posters or slogans.** You own a piece of this team's culture whether you claim it or not.

➤ IRONMIND TOOL · 01

The Pre-Game Mindset Audit

Five questions. Complete before any high-stakes moment: a game, a test, a recruiting call, a hard conversation with a teammate or a coach.

1 · WHAT IS THE OUTCOME I AM COMMITTED TO IN THIS MOMENT?

2 · WHAT STORY AM I TELLING MYSELF RIGHT NOW — AND IS IT ACCURATE?

3 · WHAT IS ONE THING I CONTROL THAT I HAVEN'T FULLY USED YET?

4 · IF MY BEST SELF WALKED OUT THERE RIGHT NOW, WHAT WOULD HE DO DIFFERENTLY THAN I'M ABOUT TO?

5 · WHAT IS THE ONE WORD I'M CARRYING INTO THIS MOMENT AS MY ANCHOR?



JOURNALING PROMPT

"What does my best self look like on my worst day?" Take ten minutes. Write without editing. Be specific — what do you do, how do you treat people, how do you talk to yourself when you're operating at your highest capacity even though everything around you is hard? That answer becomes your north star. Come back to it when the season gets long.



Mental Anticipation Skills

Win the Week Before the Game

"Champions plan the game before they're on the field."

- Why anticipation is the elite skill
 - Mapping your season in phases
 - Reading the room · The OODA Loop
 - The mental pre-mortem
 - Pressure inoculation
 - **Tool: The Challenge Map**
-

Why anticipation is the elite skill nobody talks about

Your coaches don't just react to what's happening on the field — they've already modeled a hundred versions of the game before the opening face-off. The best leaders do the same thing off the field. **Mental anticipation is not anxiety.** It is disciplined proactive thinking: mapping the terrain before you walk into it.

Anticipation means you never walk into something important cold. You've already played out the key scenarios — who might push back, where it might stall, what a win actually looks like. You've thought through what happens if the answer is no, and you have a response ready that is composed instead of defensive.

"Everyone has a plan until they get punched in the mouth. The IronMind practitioner has three plans — including one for after the punch."

IRONMIND ADVISORS, ADAPTED FROM MIKE TYSON

The mental pre-mortem

Borrowed from risk management and made famous by cognitive psychologist Gary Klein, the pre-mortem flips the usual planning mindset. Instead of asking "how will this succeed?", you ask: **"It's May, the season is over, and this completely fell apart. What happened?"** Then you work backward and build a mitigation plan for every failure point you named.

Run one on this season right now. What could go wrong? An injury to a starter? Two guys at each other's throats by March? Grades knocking somebody out? A slow start that turns into finger-pointing? A senior class that talks about standards in September and stops enforcing them in February? Name the risks and build your response before they become real. When you do this, a bad week stops being a crisis and becomes a plan you already wrote.

Mapping the season in phases

A season is not one long block. It's three, and each one asks something different of a senior leader.

PHASE	PRIMARY FOCUS	WHAT YOU BUILD	SUCCESS INDICATOR
Preseason Set the standard	Define, out loud, what this team will and won't accept. Model it before you ask for it	Trust with the younger guys; credibility with the coaching staff	Freshmen copy your behavior without being told
In-season Hold the standard	Enforce consistently, including with your friends and including on bad days	Hard conversations that don't blow up the relationship	Standards hold when the coaches aren't in the room
Final stretch Finish and hand off	Peak performance plus deliberate succession — teach the juniors what you learned	A team that doesn't collapse when you graduate	The next group is already leading before you leave

Pressure inoculation

Sports psychology has used pressure inoculation for decades: train in conditions that simulate the stress of competition so that when the real moment comes, your nervous system has already been there. Apply the same principle to everything that scares you off the field.

- Practice the recruiting call out loud three times — once alone, once with a teammate, once with someone who will ask you hard questions.
- Before a difficult conversation, write out the other person's strongest possible response, then practice answering it with composure instead of heat.
- Volunteer to speak in the huddle, to the team, or to a room of parents before you feel ready. Readiness is built in the exposure, not before it.

Reading the room: situational awareness

You already have field vision — the ability to process the whole field, not just the ball in front of you. Off the field, that becomes situational awareness: reading body language, group dynamics, and emotional undercurrents in a locker room, a classroom, or a meeting with a college coach.

- Who has the title in this room, and is it the same person who has the actual influence? On most teams it isn't.
- What's the mood walking in — flat, tense, jacked up? Adjust your approach to it instead of steamrolling it.
- Watch what isn't said. Who went quiet this week? Who stopped sitting with his group? Those are data points, and catching them early is most of the job.
- Silence is a tool. After you say the hard thing, stop talking. Let it land.

The OODA Loop

Developed by military strategist John Boyd, the OODA Loop — Observe, Orient, Decide, Act — is one of the most powerful frameworks for real-time decision-making under pressure. The person who cycles through it faster and more accurately than everyone around them has a decisive edge. You already run it on the field. Run it everywhere else.

STEP	WHAT IT MEANS	OFF-FIELD APPLICATION
Observe	Gather raw information from the environment, unfiltered	Listen fully before forming your response; read the text twice before you answer it
Orient	Filter it through your knowledge, experience, and values	Ask what you know about this person and this situation that gives the new information context
Decide	Choose a course of action, accepting incomplete information	Pick the best available option on the timeline you actually have — not the perfect one later
Act	Execute decisively, then return to observation	Move, watch what changes, adjust. Speed of the loop beats perfection of any single step

Handling team politics without becoming cynical

Every locker room has politics: who gets minutes, who's friends with whom, who has the coach's ear, who feels overlooked. Pretending otherwise is naive. The IronMind approach isn't to avoid it — it's to navigate it with integrity. Build real relationships based on respect and on what you deliver, not on trading favors or picking sides. Make sure the people who make decisions know your work and your character. Play the long game while everyone else plays the short one.

IRONMIND INSIGHT

The antidote to cynicism is a clear value system. When you know who you are and what you stand for, no current in that locker room can sweep you off course. You can navigate the landscape without becoming part of the mud — and the younger guys will notice that you did.

"Anticipation is just respect for the moment, paid in advance."

KENNY STODDART, FOUNDER — IRONMIND ADVISORS

➤ IRONMIND TOOL · 02

The Challenge Map

Anticipate the obstacles in any major goal before you begin. Use it for the season, for recruiting, or for a single hard conversation.

THE GOAL, SEASON, OR TRANSITION I AM MAPPING

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

MY RESPONSE PLAN — WHAT I DO WHEN IT DOES

RESOURCES I CAN ACTIVATE — PEOPLE, FILM, COACHES, TEAMMATES, COACH KENNY

MY NON-NEGOTIABLE COMMITMENT

What I will do regardless of how difficult this gets.

BY WHEN

HOW WE'LL KNOW IT HAPPENED

SECTION THREE

Leading Your Teammates

The Captain's Actual Job



"Titles are given. Authority is earned in the reps nobody is watching."

- What a captain actually does
- The three jobs
- Leading guys who are different from you
- Holding the standard with a friend
- Scripts that work
- **Tool: The Captain's Standard Sheet**

What a captain actually does

Most seniors think the job is to give a speech before a big game. The speech is maybe two percent of it. The job is what you do on an ordinary Tuesday, when the weather is bad, the coaches are frustrated, and a sophomore is deciding — based entirely on watching you — whether effort is required here or optional.

A real leader on this team does three things. None of them require a "C" on your jersey, and all of them are available to every senior reading this.

JOB ONE

Set the standard

Define what this team does and doesn't accept — then meet it first, every single time, especially when it costs you something.

JOB TWO

Connect the room

Know your teammates as people. Notice who's off. Pull the quiet freshman in. Nobody plays hard for a group that doesn't know him.

JOB THREE

Translate

Carry the message both ways — what the coaches need the team to hear, and what the team needs the coaches to know.

The third one is the job nobody prepares you for and the one that makes you indispensable. Your coaching staff cannot see everything. You can. When you tell a coach the truth about the room — respectfully, privately, without naming people to get them in trouble — you become a leader instead of a senior.

Authority comes from three places

- **Competence.** You do your job well. This is the entry fee, not the whole thing — the best player is not automatically the leader, and everyone in the locker room knows the difference.
- **Consistency.** You are the same guy on a good day and a bad day. People can predict you. Predictability is what makes you safe to follow.
- **Care.** They believe you want something good for them, not just from them. Without this, every correction you make sounds like an attack.

Lose any one of those and your words stop working. You can have all three by Friday if you decide to.

Holding the standard with a guy you actually like

Here is the hardest thing in this entire guide. The teammate who needs the correction is usually your friend, and the whole reason you hesitate is that you don't want to lose something. So you say nothing, the standard slips, and six weeks later you resent him for something you never told him.

Say it early, say it small, say it private. A correction delivered in week two is a conversation. The same correction delivered in April, with a season of frustration behind it, is a fight. The size of the confrontation is decided by how long you waited.

SITUATION	THE WEAK MOVE	THE IRONMIND MOVE
A teammate dogs it in conditioning	Say nothing, complain about him to two other guys	Walk with him after. "That's not you. What's going on?" Ask before you accuse
A freshman is getting frozen out	Assume someone else will handle it	Sit with him at lunch once. Make him your problem before it becomes the team's problem
A coach's decision makes no sense to the team	Let the group stew and speculate	Ask the coach privately for the reasoning so you can carry it back accurately
Someone is being ripped in the group chat	Leave it, or laugh along to stay comfortable	End it in the chat with one line, then talk to the person who started it in person
You blew it yourself	Hope nobody noticed	Name it first, in front of the group, and correct it. This buys more credibility than any speech

Scripts that work

Read these out loud until they sound like you. Rewrite them in your own words in the margin. A script you have practiced is available to you when you're angry; one you've only read is not.

CORRECTING A TEAMMATE — PRIVATELY, EARLY

"Hey. Two seconds. That last rep isn't the standard we said we'd hold, and I'd rather tell you than talk around you. I'm not coming at you — I need you, and the younger guys copy you. What do you need from me?"

ASKING A COACH FOR CLARITY WITHOUT SOUNDING LIKE A COMPLAINT

"Coach, I want to make sure I'm carrying the right message to the guys. Can you help me understand the thinking behind the change so I'm reinforcing it instead of guessing at it?"

BRINGING THE ROOM'S TEMPERATURE TO A COACH

"Coach, I'm not here to get anybody in trouble. The group is tight right now and I think it's about [specific thing]. You should have that information. Tell me what you want me to do with it."

WHEN YOU'RE THE ONE WHO GOT CALLED OUT

"You're right. That was on me. Here's what I'm changing." — Then stop talking. No explanation, no qualifier. The fastest way to earn a room is to take correction cleanly in front of it.

PULLING IN A TEAMMATE WHO HAS GONE QUIET

"You've been off this week and I noticed. You don't have to tell me anything. I'm just telling you I noticed, and I'm here. Want to grab food?"

Leading guys who aren't like you

You will lead people who are motivated differently than you are. Some need to be pushed hard in public. Some shut down completely if you do that and need it quiet and one-on-one. Some need a reason before they buy in. Some just need you to notice them once a week.

Coaching every teammate the way *you* like to be coached is the single most common leadership mistake I see, at eighteen and at fifty. The skill is simple to describe and hard to do: **find out what each guy responds to, then deliver the message in his language instead of yours.** Ask them. "How do you want it when you're messing up — loud or quiet?" Most people will tell you the truth if you ask before the moment, not during it.

THE LINE YOU DON'T CROSS

There is a difference between holding a standard and humiliating someone. The test is simple: if the correction makes him better, it's leadership. If it makes you look better, it's ego. Hazing, freezing guys out, and running a joke on someone who isn't laughing — none of that is culture. It's the cheapest version of authority there is, and it will follow you.

Succession: the part most seniors skip

You are leading a team you will leave. A senior class that leads well but teaches nothing has done half the job. Somewhere on this roster is the junior who will be standing where you're standing in twelve months, and right now he has no idea how to do it.

- Pick one underclassman and invest in him on purpose this season. Tell him you're doing it.
- Bring him into one conversation he hasn't earned yet, so he sees how it's handled.
- Hand off something real before your last game — a warm-up, a standard, a role in a team meeting.
- Tell him the thing you got wrong. What you learned the hard way is worth more than what you did well.

"The measure of your leadership isn't the record you leave. It's what happens to this team the year after you're gone."

KENNY STODDART, FOUNDER — IRONMIND ADVISORS

The Captain's Standard Sheet

Write the standard down once, so it stops being a mood and starts being a commitment. Complete it in the first two weeks, then revisit it monthly.

THE THREE STANDARDS THIS SENIOR CLASS WILL HOLD — NO MATTER WHO IS WATCHING

1.

2.

3.

WHERE I PERSONALLY FALL SHORT OF THAT STANDARD RIGHT NOW

SELF-SCORING — WHERE AM I AS A LEADER
TODAY?

1-10

WHAT A 10 WOULD LOOK LIKE THIS WEEK

Competence — I do my own job at a level that earns
the right to speak

Consistency — I am the same guy on a bad day

Care — my teammates believe I want something
good for them

Courage — I say the hard thing early instead of
waiting

THE TEAMMATE I NEED TO HAVE A CONVERSATION WITH — AND THE FIRST SENTENCE I'LL USE

THE UNDERCLASSMAN I AM DEVELOPING THIS SEASON

WHAT I WILL HAND OFF TO HIM

BY WHEN

SECTION FOUR

Energy, Boundaries & Burnout

Protecting the Engine



"You can't pour from an empty tank — and nobody is going to protect your energy for you."

- Boundaries as performance infrastructure
- Saying no without burning the relationship
- The anchor habit system
- Digital hygiene
- Early burnout signals
- **Tool: The Energy Ledger**

Boundaries aren't weakness — they're performance infrastructure

You live in a culture that rewards overload and glorifies the grind, so boundaries get a bad name. Let's correct that. Boundaries are not walls that keep people out — **they are guardrails that keep you performing at your highest level over the long haul.** Elite athletes don't train 24 hours a day. They train hard, then they recover, deliberately and non-negotiably. Your life is no different.

Your calendar right now is a full academic load, practice, lifting, film, club or showcase commitments, a job or service hours, a family, and whatever is left for sleep. If you don't protect your energy, the schedule will take all of it. Not out of malice — out of efficiency. Systems run on available capacity. If yours is always available, it gets consumed. **You are responsible for setting the limits nobody else is going to set for you.**

I learned this the most expensive way possible. For 27 years I had no limits at all and I told myself that was dedication. It wasn't. It was a slow-motion cost that I paid all at once.

"A boundary isn't a barrier. It's a declaration of what you will and won't sacrifice — and the standard by which you expect to be treated."

IRONMIND ADVISORS

Saying no without burning the relationship

The fear is legitimate: what if I look like I'm not committed? What if I lose an opportunity? The answer is that limits delivered with respect and consistency build standing rather than resentment. The key is framing. You are not refusing to work. You are proposing a structure that lets you deliver your best.

TURNING DOWN AN EXTRA COMMITMENT

"I appreciate you thinking of me. Right now I'm fully committed to [season / a class I'm fighting for] and I want to give both things the attention they deserve. Can we look at timing, or is there someone else who'd be a better fit for this one?"

ASKING A TEACHER FOR ROOM WHEN THE SCHEDULE BREAKS

"I want to be upfront with you. We're traveling Thursday and I want to turn in work at the quality you expect from me. Would you be open to [specific date]? I can commit to that."

The anchor habit system

An anchor habit is a non-negotiable daily practice that works as a reset — a signal to your nervous system that you are not at the mercy of the day. You already know this from your pre-game routine. Anchor habits do the same work everywhere else: they create predictability, regulate your state, and protect your peak window.

- **Morning anchor:** movement plus something that builds you, before you look at a screen.
- **Midday anchor:** ten minutes with no phone and no music. Just decompression.
- **Evening anchor:** a hard stop on schoolwork and a short debrief before bed.
- **Weekly anchor:** one thing you do that has nothing to do with lacrosse or grades.

Digital hygiene: the hidden burnout accelerator

The always-on expectation created by your phone is one of the biggest performance threats you face, and it is the one nobody is going to enforce for you. The research on attention and cognitive load is not ambiguous: constant connectivity degrades focus, decision quality, and recovery. The cost compounds daily.

- Notifications off during homework blocks and during film. All of them.
- Set a digital sunset — a time the phone goes down and stays down. Sleep is a performance input, not a luxury, and the phone is the single biggest thief of it.
- Recruiting content is engineered to make you feel behind. Watching another kid's commitment video at 11:40 p.m. has never made one player better. Ever.

Recognizing early burnout signals

You know what overtraining feels like. Your body stops recovering. Motivation flatlines. Performance declines despite more effort. Burnout follows the exact same pattern, and it's equally dangerous ignored.

EARLY SIGNAL	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	IRONMIND RESPONSE
Chronic fatigue	Tired even after sleep; dreading Monday by Sunday afternoon	Audit the last two weeks. What's consuming you that isn't in your top three priorities?
Cynicism creep	Rising negativity about the team, the coaches, or your future	Journal for five days on what specifically drains you. Look for the pattern, not the incident
Withdrawal	Skipping things you used to want to do; going quiet in a room you used to lead	Re-establish one anchor habit and one human contact this week. Isolation accelerates everything else
Numbing	Needing something — a screen, a scroll, a substance — to shut your head off at night	Name it out loud to one person you trust. This is the signal I ignored the longest, and it cost me the most

A WORD FROM ME, DIRECTLY

If you read that table and recognized yourself in more than one row, that is not a character flaw and it is not a reason to panic. It is information, and it is early. **Bring it to me.** The whole reason this program exists is that nobody said that to me when it would have mattered most.

The Energy Ledger

A weekly log. Track what fills your tank and what drains it. Patterns show up in three weeks that you will never notice day to day.

WEEK OF

CATEGORY	WHAT FILLED MY TANK	WHAT DRAINED MY TANK	NET 1-10
Lacrosse			
School			
Teammates & friends			
Family			
Physical health & sleep			
Mental health			

THE ONE THING THAT DRAINED ME MOST THIS WEEK — AND WHETHER I CONTROL IT

ONE ADJUSTMENT I WILL MAKE NEXT WEEK

BY WHEN

HOW I'LL KNOW IT WORKED



Recruiting & What Comes After

The Last Game Is a Date on a Calendar

"The arena doesn't end when the final buzzer sounds. It changes shape."

- Control, influence, release
 - Handling the recruiting timeline honestly
 - If you're committed · If you're not
 - The day after your last game
 - Building the non-lacrosse version of you
 - **Tool: The Transition Brief**
-

The only honest way to handle recruiting

Recruiting will try to convince you that your worth is a number of offers. It isn't, and I will not pretend otherwise just because it would be an easier thing to say. Here is the truth, and it's the same truth I'd give a 45-year-old executive in a job search: **you control your preparation, your outreach, and your response. You do not control the decision.** Spend your energy accordingly.

Most of the anxiety in this process comes from pouring effort into the third column of the tool on the next page — things you cannot move. Every hour you spend refreshing a feed is an hour you didn't spend on film, on your shot, on your GPA, or on an email to a coach who hasn't heard of you yet.

SITUATION	WHAT MOST GUYS DO	WHAT AN IRONMIND GUY DOES
Already committed	Coast. Treat the senior season as a formality	Play like the offer isn't guaranteed — because it isn't. Coaches talk, and film from this spring follows you to campus
Still waiting	Wait to be found. Assume somebody is watching	Send a specific, personal email every week. Track it. Follow up once. Nobody owes you discovery
Offers aren't coming	Take it as a verdict on your value	Widen the list, ask for honest feedback on the gap, and start building the version of your life that isn't about playing
Done playing after this year	Avoid thinking about it until May	Name it now. Decide what you're carrying forward from this team into whatever you do next

SAY THIS PART OUT LOUD

Almost everyone on this roster will play his last competitive lacrosse game at some point in the next four or five years. That is not a failure. That is math. The guys who handle it well are the ones who built something underneath the sport before they needed it. Start now, while you're still playing, when it costs you nothing.

The day after your last game

Nobody prepares you for the Tuesday after. The schedule that has organized your life since you were eight years old simply stops. The group chat goes quiet. The identity that answered "who are you?" for a decade is suddenly past tense. Some of you will feel relief. A lot of you will feel something closer to grief, and you will be confused by how heavy it is.

That feeling is not weakness and it is not a sign you're doing life wrong. It is what happens when a structure that carried meaning disappears on a schedule set by other people. The work is to build the replacement *before* the horn, not after.

KEEP

The assets

Discipline, coachability, composure under pressure, the ability to be corrected in public. All of it transfers to anything you do.

REBUILD

The structure

Training on a schedule, a competitive outlet, a group that expects you somewhere. Replace it deliberately or it will not get replaced.

ANSWER

The question

"Who am I when I'm not playing?"
Write the answer down this year, while you still have the team around you to help you find it.

Your first 90 days on campus

Whether you're walking onto a college roster or onto a campus without one, the same three phases apply. The guys who struggle freshman year are almost never the ones who lacked ability.

PHASE	FOCUS	SUCCESS INDICATOR
Days 1–30	Listen and learn. Observe the culture, learn the unwritten rules, build credibility through showing up early and doing the unglamorous things well	People see you as reliable and present — not yet as the loudest voice
Days 31–60	Contribute and connect. Add visible value. Find one older person worth learning from and one professor who knows your name	Your name comes up when someone needs something done right
Days 61–90	Own and deliver. Take clear ownership of something and finish it completely	You're trusted with something that matters, without supervision

★ YOUR NEXT STEP WITH ME

Take the **Transition Readiness Score™** at ironmindadvisors.com/transition. It takes a few minutes and it tells us both where you actually are on this — not where you think you should be. Bring the result to our next session and we'll build from it.

The Transition Brief

Separate what you control from what you don't. Do this once now, and again every time the recruiting noise gets loud.

CONTROL

Fully mine. Effort, preparation, attitude, outreach, grades, sleep.

INFLUENCE

I can move it, not decide it. Relationships, film, how coaches see me.

RELEASE

Not mine. Other people's decisions, timelines, and rosters.

WHERE I AM RIGHT NOW IN THIS PROCESS — HONESTLY, NOT THE VERSION I POST

THREE THINGS ABOUT ME THAT HAVE NOTHING TO DO WITH LACROSSE — AND THAT I WANT TO BE TRUE IN FIVE YEARS

1.

2.

3.

MY COMMITMENT FOR THE NEXT 30 DAYS OF THIS PROCESS

BY WHEN

WHO IS HOLDING ME TO IT



Mentor-On-Call

How to Find, Use, and Become a Trusted Mentor

"Every champion has a coach. Adults just call it mentorship."

- Why mentorship is highest-leverage
 - The mentorship ecosystem
 - Asking well
 - Your personal board of advisors
 - Red flags
 - **Tools: The Ask & the Prep Sheet**
-

Why mentorship is the highest-leverage move you can make

Every elite athlete has a coach. Every championship team has a staff. The idea that once you leave school you should figure everything out alone is one of the most limiting beliefs in adult culture — and the people who accelerate fastest, avoid the most expensive mistakes, and build the deepest networks are the ones who never accepted it.

A great mentor compresses your learning curve. They've already made the mistakes you're heading toward and navigated the crossroads you're approaching. They see around corners you can't see yet — not because they're smarter, but because they've been there. That knowledge, offered generously and received with humility, is worth more than any camp, certification, or seminar you'll ever pay for.

★ YOU ALREADY HAVE ACCESS — USE IT

My network is open to you

I've spent 27 years building relationships with leaders across cybersecurity, technology, medicine, law, finance, professional sport, and the trades. If you want an introduction, an informational conversation, a look at a major you're considering, or a set of eyes on an opportunity — **ask me**. Most people spend a decade building what you can borrow starting today. Use the two tools that follow to make the ask well, then bring it to our session.

ROLE	WHAT THEY PROVIDE	WHEN YOU NEED THEM
Mentor	Wisdom from lived experience; long-term guidance; personal investment in your growth	Transitions, identity questions, big decisions
Coach	Structured accountability and skill-specific improvement	A specific performance gap you want closed
Sponsor	Advocacy — they spend their own credibility on your behalf	When you're ready for something you can't reach alone
Peer	Shared-stage honesty; someone in it with you right now	Weekly. This is the one people skip, and then wonder why they feel alone

Build your personal board of advisors

Think about your support system the way a company thinks about its board: assembled on purpose, each person accountable to a specific part of your growth. Aim for three to five, and fill this in.

DOMAIN	WHAT THEY HELP YOU NAVIGATE	MY ADVISOR
Sport & performance	Skill development, recruiting decisions, playing-time reality	
Academics & career	Majors, internships, what the work actually looks like	
Wellness	Mental health, sleep, nutrition, sustainable habits	
Money	Budgeting, earning, the basics nobody teaches you	
Faith, values & purpose	The questions that don't have a stat line	

What a real mentor looks like

- They've earned the life you're building toward — in character, not just in title.
- They ask more than they tell. A great mentor helps you think; they don't download opinions on you.
- They tell you the truth, with care, without softening it into uselessness.
- They are still growing. A mentor who stopped learning stopped being a mentor.

Red flags

Not everyone who offers to help an eighteen-year-old has that eighteen-year-old's interests in mind:

- Advice that consistently serves their interests instead of yours.
- Anyone who runs down your other advisors or encourages you to keep things from your parents or coaches.
- Inappropriate personal interest dressed up as investment in your career.
- Advice that contradicts your values, framed as "how the game is really played."

⊘ TRUST YOUR GUT

If a relationship consistently leaves you feeling smaller, more confused, or more indebted rather than more capable and clear, it is not mentorship. It is leverage. Exit gracefully. If you are ever unsure whether something crosses a line, bring it to me. You will not be talked out of your own instincts here.

➤ IRONMIND TOOL · 06

The Ask

How to reach an adult who doesn't know you yet — a college coach, an alum, someone in a field you're curious about. Use it for email or a written note. Personalize every line. Never send something that reads like a template.

SUBJECT LINE — SOMETHING SPECIFIC THAT SHOWS YOU KNOW THEIR WORK. NOT "REACHING OUT"

OPENING — TWO SENTENCES MAXIMUM

"My name is [name]. I'm a senior at The Bolles School in Jacksonville, and I came across [specific thing] — it connected directly with [what you're working on]."

WHY YOU — BRIEF AND SPECIFIC

"I'm [position / student / background] and I'm working through [specific thing]. I learned [specific detail] from your [talk / career / program] and it already changed how I approach [something concrete]."

THE ASK — CONCRETE AND LOW-COMMITMENT

"I'd be grateful for 20 minutes at your convenience to ask you [specific question]. I'll come prepared and I'll respect your time completely."

CLOSING AND CONTACT

► IRONMIND TOOL · 07

Mentor Meeting Prep Sheet

Complete this before every mentor conversation. An adult will always give more to a young person who shows up prepared — and they can tell within ninety seconds.

DATE & WHO I'M MEETING

SINCE WE LAST TALKED — WHAT DID I ACTUALLY DO ABOUT IT?

MY TOP THREE QUESTIONS FOR THIS CONVERSATION

1.

2.

3.

THE SPECIFIC CHALLENGE I WANT THEIR PERSPECTIVE ON — CONTEXT, WHAT I'VE TRIED, THE OUTCOME I WANT

WHAT I WILL DO WITHIN SEVEN DAYS OF THIS MEETING

BY WHEN

HOW I'LL THANK THEM — SPECIFIC, NOT GENERIC



The IronMind Daily Protocol

How Elite Performers Actually Operate

"Elite performers don't just think differently — they operate differently."

- Why protocols beat motivation
 - Morning protocol
 - School & practice protocol
 - Evening protocol
 - The weekly "game film" review
 - **Tool: The Weekly Scorecard**
-

Why protocols beat motivation every time

Motivation is a feeling. Feelings are unreliable — you already know this, because you have played well on days you didn't feel like playing. **Protocols are systems**, and systems produce results whether you feel like it or not. Every elite performer you admire runs on structured routines that remove the question "what should I do now?" from the day. When the decision is already made, you spend zero energy making it. That energy goes to performance instead.

This is not a rigid schedule. It's a framework around the three high-leverage windows of your day. Stack them consistently and they compound. Miss one and recover without guilt. Abandon them entirely and you'll feel the gap within two weeks.

"You don't rise to the level of your goals. You fall to the level of your systems. Build systems worthy of your goals."

IRONMIND ADVISORS, ADAPTED FROM JAMES CLEAR

Morning protocol — 15 to 20 minutes

5 MIN

Mindset anchor

Before any screen. Breathe. Read one page of something that builds you. Anchor to who you are before the world tells you who to be.

5–10 MIN

Physical activation

Not a workout — activation. Stretch, walk, push-ups. Your brain works better once your body has moved.

3–5 MIN

Intention setting

Write the single most important thing you'll do today. Not the list. The one thing that makes the day a win regardless of what else happens.

School and practice protocol

- **Deep work blocks:** schedule 45–90 minutes of uninterrupted work on the hardest subject first. Notifications off, phone out of the room. Non-negotiable.
- **Decision pacing:** handle the highest-stakes thinking early, when your cognitive resources peak. Defer low-stakes decisions to the afternoon.
- **Practice arrival:** the last ten minutes before you walk on the field are yours. Leave school in the locker room. Run your pre-game mindset audit on ordinary days, not just game days.
- **Micro-breaks:** every 90 minutes, take a real ten-minute break away from screens. That is how your brain consolidates what you just did.
- **Midday energy check:** rate your energy 1–10. Below a 6? Take the fastest legitimate recovery available — walk, food, water, or two minutes with someone who fills your tank.

Evening protocol

- **Debrief (5 min):** what did I do that mattered? What did I learn? What would I do differently? Written answers. Sustained over a season, this one practice produces extraordinary self-awareness.
- **Gratitude (3 min):** three specific things from today. Not "my family" — "the conversation with Coach that went better than I expected." Specificity is what makes it a real practice instead of a platitude.
- **Tomorrow's single priority:** write it before you shut down. Decision made, load reduced. Sleep improves when your brain isn't still working on unfinished business.
- **Phone down before you're tired.** Sleep is the cheapest performance gain available to you and the one you're most likely to trade away.

The weekly review: game film for your life

Championship coaches don't just coach the next game — they watch film from the last one, objectively, without ego, looking for patterns instead of incidents. The IronMind Weekly Review applies that same discipline to your life. Twenty minutes, every Sunday night, with the scorecard on the next page.

DAY	MORNING	PRIORITY	EVENING
Monday	Mindset anchor, movement, intention	Week review; hardest subject first	Debrief + gratitude + tomorrow's one thing
Tuesday	Reading, activation, intention	Practice with a specific technical focus	Debrief + energy ledger update
Wednesday	Mindset anchor, movement, intention	Midweek reset; one teammate check-in	Debrief + gratitude
Thursday	Reading, activation, intention	Relationship building; one mentor or coach email sent	Debrief + tomorrow's one thing
Friday	Game-day or pre-game routine	Close loops. Deliver what you promised	Debrief + the week's lesson
Saturday	Movement, unstructured	Compete, or rest and recover on purpose	Light debrief
Sunday	Rest, faith, family, solitude	Plan the week; 20-minute game film review	Set next week's #1 priority

The Weekly Scorecard

Review your week the way your coaches review film: objectively, without ego, looking for the pattern.

WEEK OF

PERFORMANCE DOMAIN	1-10	BIGGEST WIN	ADJUSTMENT FOR NEXT WEEK
Lacrosse performance			
Leadership			
Academics			
Mental toughness			
Relationships			
Physical health & sleep			
IronMind protocol			

THIS WEEK'S SINGLE MOST IMPORTANT LESSON — IN YOUR OWN WORDS, THE WAY YOU'D EXPLAIN IT TO A TEAMMATE

NEXT WEEK'S #1 PRIORITY — ONE THING, THE MOST IMPORTANT THING

BY WHEN

HOW I'LL KNOW I DID IT



You Were Built for This

"The arena has changed shape. But you are still a competitor."

You made it to the end of this guide. That alone tells me something about you.

Most guys pick up something like this, read four pages, put it down, and go back to what's comfortable. You didn't. You read the hard parts and sat with the questions I asked. That is exactly the kind of person who wins the long game.

You have already proven you can perform under pressure. You've already shown up when it was hard. You've already lost something — a game, a season, a spot, a version of yourself you held onto tightly — and you kept going. That is not a small thing. It is the exact foundation the next ten years will test.

Here's what I need you to know

The tools only work if you use them. Reading is not preparation. Doing is preparation. Pick one tool from this guide and run it this week. Then pick another. Build momentum with action, not intention.

You will have bad days. Days when the mindset audit feels hollow, the energy ledger looks embarrassing, and the morning protocol sounds exhausting. On those days — especially those days — do it anyway. That's the entire point.

You are not supposed to figure this out alone. You have three things most people your age don't: a network you can borrow, a coach who will tell you the truth, and a group of guys going through the identical thing at the identical time. Use all three. Build your board. Reach for a mentor. And when the time comes — and it will — be the mentor somebody else needed and never had.

The arena has changed shape, but you are still a competitor. Your field vision, your competitive drive, your coachability, your ability to perform when it's uncomfortable — all of it transfers. All of it counts. All of it is an edge that most people around you will never develop.

My mission is to equip the next generation of leaders with the mental toughness, clarity, and infrastructure to lead what's coming instead of surviving it. The senior class in front of me decides what this team is this season — and, more than you realize, what it is after you're gone.

I am proud of you. And most of the work is still ahead.

Now go be great. I'll see you at our next session.

Kenny Stoddart

Founder & CEO, IronMind Advisors · "Coach Kenny"

This guide is the beginning, not the end.

THE IRONMIND SENIOR COMMITMENT

I will hold the standard I wrote down, including on the days it costs me something. I will say the hard thing early, and I will leave this team better than I found it.

SIGNED

DATE

YOUR STANDING INVITATION

Bring me the real thing

Bring what actually happened this week — the coach who got on you, the teammate you can't reach, the email you don't know how to answer. Real advice, no script. **Show up.**

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Point your camera at the code —
follow the work



IronMind Elite × The Bolles School Bulldogs Lacrosse

A program of IronMind Advisors · Kenny Stoddart, Founder & CEO · Jacksonville Beach, FL